

0.0.1 Andhakavinda

1. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Andhakavinda in Magadha. At that time the Auspicious One was seated in the open air during the pitch black darkness of the night and the [rain] deva was drizzling drop by drop.

2. Then when the night had advanced, the Brahma Sahampati, of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the entire Andhakavinda, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he stood to one side. Having stood to one side, the Brahma Sahampati spoke these verses in the Auspicious One's presence:

One should frequent remote lodgings,

andhakavindasuttam

ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā māgadhesu² viharati andhakavinde. tena kho pana samayena bhagavā rattandhakāratimisāyaṃ ajjhokāse³ nisinno hoti. devo ca ekamekaṃ phusāyati.

atha kho brahmā sahampati abhikkantāya rattiyaṃ abhikkantavaṇṇo kevalakappaṃ andhakavindam obhāsetvā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamtvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhāsi. ekamantaṃ ṭhito kho brahmā sahampati bhagavato santike imā gāthāyo abhāsi:

sevetha pantāni senāsanāni¹,

one should fare liberated
from the fetters;
should one not gain de-
light there,
then live amidst the San-
gha as a self-guarded,
mindful one.

Wandering from family
to family for alms food,
that prudent, mindful
one, with faculties
guarded;
must frequent remote
lodgings,
free from dread, liber-
ated, fearless.

The place where frightful
snakes roam,
wherethe Deva streaks
lightning and thunders;
sitting down in the pitch
darkness of the night,
there, that bhikkhu is rid
of dread.

This indeed, has undoubt-
edly been seen by me,

careyya saññojanavip-
pamokkhā;
sace ratim nādhigac-
cheyya tattha,
saṅghe vase rakkhi-
tatto satīmā².

kulākulaṃ piṇḍikāya
caranto,
indriyagutto nipako
satīmā²;
sevetha pantāni senā-
sanāni,
bhayā pamutto abhaye
vimutto.

yattha bheravā sirim-
sapā³,
vijju sañcarati tha-
neti⁴ devo;
andhakāratimisāya
rattiyā nisīdi,
tattha bhikkhu vigata-
lomahaṃso.

idaṃ hi jātu me diṭ-
ṭhaṃ,
nayidaṃ itihītihaṃ;

this is not hearsay;
in [this] life of purity
alone,
a thousand have dis-
pelled death.

More than five hundred
sekhas,
and ten tenfold are seen;
all are endowed with the
stream,
not destined for the ani-
mal womb.

But this other population,
“[those] partaking in mer-
its;”
this mind of mine is not
even able to calculate,
for fear of uttering false
speech.

ekasmiṃ brahmacari-
yasmim,
sahassaṃ maccuhāyi-
naṃ.

bhiyyo⁵ pañcasatā
sekhā,
dasā ca dasadhā dasa;

sabbe sotasaṃāpannā,

atiracchānagāmino.

athāyaṃ itarā pajā,
puññabhāgāti me mano;

saṅkhātuṃ nopi sak-
komi,
musāvādassa otta-
peti⁶

